



Digital Revolution in 2025

A study by McAfee reveals that with security and privacy concerns being prevalent, Indian consumers are predicting a digital revolution in 2025.



Four new apps from ICICI

ICICI has launched four next generation apps including ICICI Store, Insta Banking, Video Banking and mPassbook to enhance the banking experience for its customers

Agent 001



Gaming laptop extraordinaire?

Q Gaming laptop: Worth it?

Now, coming to the cause; I am confused between this rig (specification suggested by you) and Lenovo Y50-70 series (i7 HQ processor, hybrid HDD, 8 GB ddr3, 2GB gddr5 graphics, 1080p screen etc, costing around ₹77,000/- in retail market) gaming laptop. I know a desktop and laptop can't be compared on same parance. Still I need your view about which choice would be better based on which factors, keeping aside the mobility issue. And, please tell me as to whether its a myth that gaming laptops can't survive or endure for years as a gaming desktop or its a fact? I am eagerly waiting for your response.

– Nirad Dixit

A For those of us who can't splurge on Alienware or ASUS ROG or MSI gaming laptops, the next best alternative is something like the Lenovo Y50-70, which is a successor to Lenovo's Y510p (which I had a chance to play with last year). I have it on good authority that the machine is built for multimedia and gaming enthusiasts, however I personally haven't seen it in action and can't comment on its performance. However, it does have very good hardware packed in at the price.

Mobility is the only variable here that should define your choice whether you want a desktop or laptop for gaming. Nothing else matters.

Companies that make dedicated gaming laptops like the Alienwares, ASUSes, MSIs, and more, of the world do spend considerably on the cooling and structural aspect of the laptop's build, which in turn helps the overall longevity of the device. Purely because laptops

are prone to experience the elements (outdoors, indoors, cold, hot, humidity, blowing air, dust, etc) a lot more than a desktop PC would, they are more probable to wear and tear earlier. But if you don't take care of your desktop PC (clean it, dust it, protect it, etc), it's not going to be bulletproof either. It's unrealistic to expect devices like laptops to be relevant after 3-5 years, and if they last that long without any defect it's some worth cherishing.

Q Which headphone to buy?

Guys I need your advice on this. I want to buy a headphone and my priority is sound quality. I have shortlisted two headphones. One is JBL J88 and the other is the Sony WH303 3 in 1 headphone. The WH303 is an exciting gadget as it has many nice additional features but as I said, my priority is sound quality. Tell me which one I should buy.

– Shubham Rana

A We haven't tried the Sony NWZ-WH303 but from the description it seems gimmicky. Most gadgets that try to pack in too many things – in this case wireless capability, an MP3 player, and speakers – can rarely manage to fulfil their core purpose properly. The J88 isn't bad, just a little more bass heavy than we'd like. If that's your thing then go for it. Try to hunt for the Koss Porta Pro – they're good. Also one of our all time favourites, the Harman Kardon CL, on-ear is on sale over at Amazon for a 50 percent discount (₹5000 instead of ₹10,000). It can't sweeter than that.



Harman Kardon headphones are really good. No, we mean they're really good!

Q Which screen protector?

Which Is the best screen protectors Nilkin or Godosmith tempered glass? And how does one evaluate how good / effective screen protectors are?

– Abhinash Mishra

A An easy way to find this out is to watch a few YouTube videos where the prowess of these protectors are put to the test. If you are looking at the technical aspects then a screen protector has to be subjected



Screen protectors are important, aye?

to common items found in the average person's pocket like keys, metal pens and all sorts of jewellery including the precious stones set in rings. Why these objects? Because they are hard enough to scratch the glass on your mobile phone. Precious stones are some of the hardest known materials and the fact that they're likely to be found in one's pocket is all the more a reason that they should one of the things used to scratch a screen protector. Drop tests are useless since the screen is likely to shatter from the shock-wave whether there is a protector affixed or not.

Then they need to be subjected to visual tests to decide if the colours of the display seem to be affected or not. And the last point is to check the thickness and cutting of the edges.

We searched for both these brands and what we found was that most people could never test the two protectors because the first one they'd bought never needed to be replaced. So we'd peg these two at the same level of quality. But there were instances where the Nilkin was reported to not have properly cut edges. So you decide. **A**